

In Loving Memory



Paul Yensing Yee

11-07-1932 to 09-11-2016

Yoshie Nakajima Yee

12-3-1931 to 04-16-2024

Laid to rest at
Greenwood Memorial Park
05-06-2024



Graveside Service for
Yoshie Nakajima Yee & Paul Yee
(Dec 03, 1931 - Apr 16, 2024)
Greenwood Memorial Park
May 6, 2024, 10am

Opening Prayer

Good morning, beloved. Let us pray.

Eternal God whose image we bear,
unsearchable forest of peace and comfort,
indescribable sea of love,
fountain of blessings,
and source of all affection—
you send peace to those who receive it.
Open us today to receive your sea of love,
and water us with abundant streams
from the riches of your grace,
and from the sweet springs of your kindness.

You, oh God, are our eternal parent,
and we are heirs of your comfort and peace.
Kindle in our hearts a warm fire of your endless love,
sit beside us in the cold of the night,
and strengthen our weakness with your power.

Bring us close to you and to each other in an unshakeable bond of unity, as
your spirit comforts us and we comfort each other. Amen

I am Rachel Cooley Shawler, a minister at Kensington Community Church, where we are blessed to have Simon, Danielle, Kiyoshi, & Kenji as members and as living legacies of Yoshie & Paul.

I am truly honored to join you in companionship on behalf of the church - Thank you all for letting our church join in your remembrance.

In the stillness of this place we turn to God who is our beginning & our end. From dust we have been made and to dust we return. With reverence we gather to thank God for the gifts of Yoshie and Paul to us, and to commit their earthly bodies to the ground with the confidence that neither life nor death can separate any of us from the love of God.

Paul & Yoshie were devoted companions here on earth, as we know they are in the eternity of love now. We honor their love & partnership by committing their remains to be together buried.

We hold in grateful memory these beloved ones not separated from us by death. Though we cannot return them to life, we can remember them and know that their legacies are fixed within our hearts forever. We can celebrate the fullness of their lives, with all their strengths, foibles, uniqueness, and weaknesses; and have joy in the ties that bind us forever together.

Those stories and moments are holy; they are sacred anchors of the connection that remains even when apart. They are the one of the ways that love continues to bind us even in life and death.

Blessing of the ground

And now we begin our memory by blessing the ground that will hold Paul & Yoshie's bodies when we leave. We bless it with our presence, with memories, with the ways Paul's love & Yoshie's love live on in you all, cannot be separated because they are in your very cores, in the ways you were formed & grew, in the acts of love which nourished you.

Pause

This is a holy ground, full of reminders of those who have left their mark on this world. Places like this give physical space to mark our grief, to remember and celebrate a life no longer with us in body. Today, as we lay Paul & Yoshie to rest, we remember those who have gone before them and recognize that they too are now a part of that great cloud of witnesses.

Will you join me in prayer.

Gracious God,

May this ground be blessed, consecrated as a holy place as it holds the remains of Yoshie & Paul Yee on earth while you hold their spirits.

May your Spirit illuminate us towards peace beyond understanding, hope in the midst of sorrow, and brilliance of love that reaches beyond even death.

Marked here by a memorial, a sign that as they dwell with God and—in a new way—with us, a sign of the love shared by those who love them, a sign of the work they did on earth and the work which continues as we live here and now, honoring their legacies in the lives we live.

Grant us grace today, that though those gathered here grieve the losses of Paul & Yoshie, and that we might remember doing so as an expression of love.

Be our peace, be our hope and no matter where we are or what we bring today, no matter what feelings are present, ground us in that hope of peace beyond understanding.

And above all may we know that nothing, not even death is apart from your boundless love.

Amen.

Sharing of memories

Are there any words that long to be shared?

If anyone in the family would like to share memories or comments about Paul & Yoshie as we lay them to rest, you may do so now.

Scripture

Prayer of Committal

As we move from remembering these beloveds to sitting with our sadness, it is time to commit Paul and Yoshie's bodies to the earth and commend their spirits to God in heaven.

e Psalms

Lord, you have been our dwelling place
in all generations.
Before the mountains were brought forth,
or ever you had formed the earth and the world,
from everlasting to everlasting you are God.
You turn us back to dust,
and say, "Turn back, you mortals."
For a thousand years in your sight
are like yesterday when it is past,
or like a watch in the night.
You sweep them away; they are like a dream,
like grass that is renewed in the morning;
in the morning it flourishes and is renewed;
in the evening it fades and withers.
The days of our life are seventy years,
or perhaps eighty, if we are strong.
So teach us to count our days
that we may gain a wise heart.

(PSALM 90:1-6, 10, 12)

Other appropriate psalms:

Psalm 23—The Divine Shepherd
Psalm 42:1-8—Longing for God and help in distress
Psalm 46—God is with us
Psalm 121—Assurance of God's protection
Psalm 130—Hope in God
Psalm 139—God's eternal presence

brew Scriptures *God speaks*

But now ~~thus says the LORD,~~
~~he~~ who created you, O Jacob,
~~he~~ who formed you, O Israel:
Do not fear, for I have redeemed you;
I have called you by name, you are mine.
When you pass through the waters, I will be with you;
and through the rivers, they shall not overwhelm you;
when you walk through fire you shall not be burned,
and the flame shall not consume you.
For I am the LORD your God,
the Holy One of Israel, your Savior.
Do not fear, for I am with you;
I will bring your offspring from the east,
and from the west I will gather you;
I will say to the north, "Give them up,"
and to the south, "Do not withhold;

bring my sons from far away
and my daughters from the end of the earth—
everyone who is called by my name,
whom I created for my glory,
whom I formed and made."
I am God, ~~and also henceforth I am He;~~
there is no one who can deliver from my hand;
I work and who can hinder it?
I am the LORD, your Holy One, the Creator of Israel, your King.
Do not remember the former things,
or consider the things of old.
I am about to do a new thing;
now it springs forth, do you not perceive it?
I will make a way in the wilderness
and rivers in the desert.

I, I am He
who blots out your transgressions for my own sake,
and I will not remember your sins.

~~Thus says the LORD, the King of Israel,~~
~~and his Redeemer, the LORD of hosts:~~

I am the first and I am the last;
~~besides me there is no god.~~

Do not fear, or be afraid;
~~I have~~ I have not told you from of old and declared it?
You are my witnesses!

(ISAIAH 43:1-3A, 5-7, 13, 15, 18-19, 25; 44:6, 8A)

Other appropriate passages from Hebrew scripture:

Isaiah 40:1-8—The comfort of God
Isaiah 40:28-31—Power to the faint
Lamentations 3:22-26; 31-33—God is good

New Testament Readings

Now I would remind you, brothers and sisters,
of the good news that I proclaimed to you,
which you in turn received, in which also you stand,
through which also you are being saved.
Now if Christ is proclaimed as raised from the dead,
how can some of you say there is no resurrection of the dead?
For if the dead are not raised, then Christ has not been raised.
If Christ has not been raised,
your faith is futile and you are still in your sins.
Then those also who have died in Christ have perished.
But in fact Christ has been raised from the dead,
the first fruits of those who have died.
But someone will ask, "How are the dead raised?
With what kind of body do they come?"

We now commend Yoshie's soul to God, and Paul's soul to God, even as we commit her body and his body to this place of rest. Let us go forth trusting in the everlasting love that created and sustains us. As Yoshie & Paul are embraced in God's arms, let us also find comfort in God's peace that passes understanding.

Eternal God, who breathes into lifeless dust and brings forth people in your image, today we return to the earth the bodies of our beloved parents, grandparents, sisters, friends, and companions, believing that as you raised Jesus Christ from death, you will breathe life into us again so that we may live with you for ever.

Amen.

—Moment of silence—

Prayer of thanksgiving

God of Heaven,
In whose heart we find our eternal home:
There is none like you.
There is none who knows our sorrows like you,
None who sits with us in lovingkindness like you.
None who accompanies us in our grief and in our joy like you do.
You join us in our sadness and in our smiles.
You guide our paths day and night,
holding our hearts when they grow heavy and weigh down our walk
through life.

Give us, God the companionship of one another.

Teach us to carry to one another your comfort, revealing to each other
your gentle mercies in the love you have taught us, and in the love
Paul & Yoshie modeled, and wish for us.

The author Terry Tempest Williams “grief dares us to love once more”

We are so grateful to you for them God

We bring this and all our prayers to you today just as your Son Jesus
taught us to pray—:

Benediction

The poet bell hooks says that, "To be loving is to be open to grief, to be
touched by sorrow, even sorrow that is unending."

"The way we grieve," hooks says, "is informed by whether we know love.
Love casts out fear, and then love guides us as in our grief."

Beloved, as we depart from this intimate time, may God give you the gift of
an intimate grief.

May the love and strength Yoshie & Paul modeled guide you through this
grief.

May God give you comfort and companionship in your grief.

May your hearts expand, building the muscles needed to hold each other when
the hurt hurts too much to be on your own,

And may those same hearts come to know that Paul & Yoshie are within them, that we may consult them on the journey & remember their legacy such that we recognize them walking with us.

May you be blessed, richly, with overflowing hearts, by the God who was, and is, and will be forevermore by our sides.

Amen.